

Ruffled-strap milkmaid babydoll dress

EU38 sewing guide . 9 pieces . 2.1 m fabric at 140 cm

text-first guide, no illustrations in this edition. Every step is the engine's own instruction.

Cut list

Bodice Front - cut 1 on fold

Bodice Back - cut 2

Skirt Front - cut 1 on fold

Skirt Back - cut 2 (center back seam)

Neck/Front Tie (ön ba) - cut 2 rectangle(s) 80 x 380 mm (finished 25 x 350 mm), attach at the front neckline/centre front and kn

Shirred Yoke Panel (büzgüyaka panosu) - cut 1 rectangle(s) 960 x 160 mm (join to a 930 mm flat top edge that gathers down to

Steps

1. Print and check the 3 cm calibration square before cutting.
2. This block uses standard assumptions for shoulder slope, underbust sew a quick muslin (test version) from cheap fabric first and adjust before cutting your real fabric.
3. Cut every piece as labelled: pieces marked 'on fold' on the fabric fold, 'cut 2' twice.
4. Staystitch the neckline just inside the seam line so it doesn't stretch while you work.
5. Sew all darts first, pressing toward the center.
6. Sew the bodice shoulder seams and press them open.
7. Prepare the neckline bias strip: join the ends as needed and press it in half lengthwise along the marked fold line.
8. Bind the neckline with the bias strip, right sides together and raw edges even, leaving the last 2 cm free at each center back edge (the zipper goes there later). Ease the strip gently around the curves. Trim to 6 mm, turn the folded edge to the inside and topstitch or slipstitch it down.
9. Sew the bodice side seams.
10. Finish each armhole the same way with its bias strip: press it in half, bind the armhole right sides together, ease around the curve, then turn and topstitch it to the inside.
11. Gather the skirt panels along the marked line until they match the bodice waist.
12. Sew the skirt seams (leave the center back seam open where the zipper will go), then join bodice to skirt at the underbust seam (the empire line sits right under the bust), matching side seams.
13. Insert an invisible zipper in the center back through bodice and skirt: install the zipper BEFORE closing the seam below it, then close the rest of the seam.
14. Fold the free binding ends back over the zipper tape and hand-tack them down so the edge sits clean against the zipper.

15. Try it on, then hem with a 2 cm double fold.
16. Ties (ba): cut the tie rectangle(s) as labelled, fold each in half lengthwise right sides together, stitch the long edge and one short end, turn right side out and press. Stitch the raw end to the marked placement notch (right sides together, caught in the seam), then knot into a bow. The tie is self-fabric cut on the straight grain.
17. Shirred gathering (büzgü): cut the panel. Wind elastic thread on the bobbin and sew along each marked shirring row (right side up); the elastic pulls the panel down to about half its flat width (2:1) as you sew the rows. Steam to tighten. Join the gathered edge to the body at the placement notch, matching the finished length.
18. Ruffled straps (f1rf1rl1 ask1): cut the two strap rectangles as labelled. Fold each in half lengthwise right sides together, stitch the long edge and one short end, turn right side out and press. Run two rows of gathering along the marked gather line and pull each strip down to the marked strap span so it ruffles evenly. Stitch each gathered end to its shoulder placement notch one end at the front, the other at the back catching it in the top-edge seam. The strap is self-fabric; cut on the straight grain.